TOPIC REPORTS: CYBERSECURITY

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

CONNECTIVITY · DATA STORAGE · ENERGY · TECHNICAL CAPACITY · CYBERSECURITY

Benin · Burkina Faso · Cameroon · Cape Verde · Chad · Comoros · Cote d'Ivoire · Equatorial Guinea · Eswatini · Ethiopia · Gabon · Ghana · Kenya · Liberia · Libya · Malawi · Mauritania · Mozambique · Namibia · Nigeria · Rwanda · Seychelles · Sierra Leone · South Africa · Sudan · Tanzania · Togo · Tunisia · Uganda · Zimbabwe

Benin

CLUB OF INFORMATION-SECURITY OFFICERS (CLUB DES RSSI)

- **Cybersécurité au Bénin: Le club des Rssi porté sur les fonts baptismaux** — La Nation Bénin, 29 September 2026

  Benin's information security officers founded a professional club at a constituent general assembly on 26 September 2026, adopting statutes and electing an 11-member board chaired by Athanase Atchome. The club plans training, workshops, experience sharing and promotion of international security standards across public and private institutions.

NATIONAL DIGITAL INVESTIGATIONS CENTRE COMPLAINT POINTS

- **Bénin : le CNIN ouvre trois points de plainte à Porto-Novo, Abomey et Parakou** — Bénin Web TV, 3 October 2026

  Benin's National Centre for Digital Investigations, CNIN, which reports to the Presidency, opened three complaint desks outside Cotonou, in police premises at Porto-Novo, Abomey and Parakou. They take complaints about personal data breaches and digital offences, alongside the Cotonou office and the existing email route.

Burkina Faso

CYBERCRIME BRIGADE AWARENESS STUDIO

- **Lutte contre les fake news : La BCLCC se dote d'un studio pour renforcer la sensibilisation des internautes** — leFaso.net, 8 September 2026

  Burkina Faso's central anti-cybercrime brigade, the BCLCC, has set up an audiovisual studio to produce public awareness content on online risks. Short videos will debunk false information and explain how to verify it, and other content will cover protecting personal data and accounts. No cost or launch date is given.

REPORTED FINANCIAL LOSS TO CYBERCRIME

- **[Interview] cybercriminalité au Burkina, un préjudice de 1,7 milliards de FCFA enregistré en 2025, (Lieutenant Napougba Julien Legma)** — Libreinfo.net, 14 September 2026

> Burkina Faso recorded FCFA 906,123,245 in cybercrime losses in the first half of 2026, against FCFA 1.7 billion for the whole of 2025, Lieutenant Napougba Julien Legma of the central anti-cybercrime brigade said in an interview published on 14 September 2026. More than 1,000 complaints have been lodged so far this year.

Cameroon

> CYBERCRIME COMPLAINTS AND INCIDENTS RECORDED BY THE ICT AGENCY

- **Lutte contre la cybercriminalité: La riposte nationale s'organise** — Cameroon Tribune, 30 September 2026

  Cameroon's ICT agency ANTIC reported 17,500 cybercrime complaints in 2025 with declared losses of 5.8 billion FCFA, at a cyberspace-security forum it co-hosts with the Russian embassy in Yaoundé. Since January it has counted 21,280 compromised machines and 39 attacks on government websites.

Cape Verde

> IMPERSONATION PHISHING AGAINST THE POSTAL OPERATOR

- **Correios de Cabo Verde alertam para mensagens fraudulentas** — Expresso das Ilhas, 8 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's postal operator, Correios de Cabo Verde, warned on 8 September 2026 that people impersonating its staff are sending messages asking recipients to click a link named 'Correios.ink/cv'. The operator said the link is not its own and advised the public not to click it or share personal or banking details.

Chad

> MINISTRY CIRCULAR BANNING OFFICIAL DOCUMENTS ON MESSAGING APPS

- **Tchad : le ministère de la Femme durcit le ton contre la fuite de documents sur les réseaux sociaux** — Alwihda Info, 25 September 2026

  Chad's Ministry of Women and Early Childhood banned the sending of official documents over WhatsApp, Messenger and other mobile apps, in a circular signed by Minister of State Kitoko Gata Ngoulol and reported on 25 September 2026. It found that officials, including senior staff, routinely shared correspondence and decisions this way; breaches are now disciplinary faults. The circular's date is not given.

Comoros

> INFORMATION-SECURITY MEMORANDUM WITH RUSSIA

- **Comores-Russie I Une cooperation bilaterale appelee a «franchir un nouveau cap»** — Al-Watwan, 17 September 2026

  A Russian embassy delegation visiting the Comoros took up with the telecommunications minister the information-security memorandum the two governments had already initialled, covering professional training, skills-building and action against cybercrime. The Comorian side proposed a further document on training Comorian trainers; the same visit prepared the opening of a Russian embassy in Moroni.

Cote d'Ivoire

> CYBER.EX NATIONAL CYBER-CRISIS SIMULATION

- **Cybersécurité : la Côte d'Ivoire organise sa première simulation nationale de crise cyber - Abidjan.net News** — Abidjan.net, 13 October 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's information-systems security agency will run a first national cyber-crisis simulation in Abidjan on 28 and 29 October 2026.

Equatorial Guinea

ALLEGED LEAK OF OFFICIAL DOCUMENTS OF THE PRESIDENCY OF THE GOVERNMENT

- **El vicepresidente revela nombres vinculados a una presunta masiva filtración de documentos oficiales de Guinea Ecuatorial** — Revista Real Equatorial Guinea, 9 October 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-president, Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue, named on X the alleged members of a network leaking official documents from the Presidency of the Government. He alleged that a registry official extracted several years of administrative files and handed a hard drive to a third party under the pretext of a project to digitise the Presidency's archives. The account is the government's; no court finding is reported.

Eswatini

NATIONAL CYBER DRILL

- **ESCCOM HOSTS INAUGURAL NATIONAL CYBER DRILL TO STRENGTHEN ESWATINI'S CYBER RESILIENCE** — The Bridge, 8 October 2026

  Eswatini held its first national cyber drill on 5 October: a multi-sector ransomware simulation for energy, telecoms, government, aviation, health and finance, facilitated by Lesotho's regulator. The communications commission showed a prototype incident-sharing platform.

Ethiopia

FINANCIAL SECTOR CYBERSECURITY FORUM

- **Ethiopia establishes financial sector cybersecurity forum to improve digital resilience** — Tech Review Africa, 30 September 2026

  Ethiopia set up a Financial Sector Cybersecurity Forum on 29 September, chaired jointly by the cyber agency INSA and the National Bank, for threat sharing and coordinated incident response across financial institutions.

Gabon

RECORDED INTRUSION ALERTS

- **Cybermenaces : 900 000 alertes en 60 jours, le Gabon passe en vigilance renforcée** — GabonReview, 8 September 2026

  More than 900,000 intrusion alerts were recorded in Gabon over 60 days, some rated very critical, after several attacks on national bodies. Digital economy minister Mark-Alexandre Doumba said on 7 September 2026 that the government had raised its vigilance level and called on administrations, firms and citizens to treat cybersecurity as a permanent duty.

- **Cybermenaces : ce que l'ANINF dit vraiment des 900 000 alertes qui font polémique** — GabonReview, 10 September 2026

  Gabon's national agency pushed back against reading its 900,000 intrusion alerts as evidence of a vulnerable national digital system, saying the figure shows a system capable of seeing threats rather than one already submerged by them. In a dossier seen by the publication it addresses the confusions in the public reaction and the controversy over firewalls.

ANINF-KASPERSKY CYBERSECURITY COMPETENCE CENTRE, LIBREVILLE

- **Cybersécurité : le Gabon renforce ses défenses face aux attaques dopée** — Échos de l'Éco, 8 October 2026

At a Kaspersky seminar in Libreville on 7 October 2026, an agreement between Gabon's digital infrastructure agency ANINF and Kaspersky was reported to provide for a Libreville competence centre for threat monitoring and skills transfer. The national strategy also plans a CSIRT and a security operations centre. In September the government reported over 900,000 intrusion alerts in 60 days, not all of them successful intrusions.

Ghana

REPORTED CYBERCRIME LOSSES AND INCIDENT REPORTS

- **AI now enables 55% of cybercrime in Africa as losses hit $484m – CID** — GBC Ghana Online (Ghana Broadcasting Corporation), 2 September 2026 AFRICA

  Ghana's police CID put Interpol's 2026 African Cyber Threat Assessment on the record at the awareness month launch: AI now enables 55% of reported cybercrime in Africa, with related losses of $484 million. CID director-general COP Lydia Yaako Donkor described generative AI supplying convincing phishing messages, cloned voices and synthetic images and video, with cryptocurrency, mule accounts and fraudulent investment schemes moving the proceeds — an industrialised, borderless ecosystem rather than isolated offending. She tied Ghana's exposure directly to the spread of mobile money, internet banking and instant transfers.

- **Ghana records GH¢209m in cybercrime losses in nine months** — Graphic Online, 15 October 2026

  Ghana's Cyber Security Authority recorded GH¢209.7m in losses from 4,938 reported cyber incidents in the first nine months of 2026, against GH¢22.5m for the whole of 2025. Online fraud made up 48% of cases, and the authority says it works with Meta and TikTok to take down child sexual exploitation material.

NATIONAL COMPUTER EMERGENCY RESPONSE TEAM

- **Cyber Security Authority (CSA) Ghana opens NCSAM 2026 with call for stronger cybersecurity collaboration** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Ghana's Cyber Security Authority opened its 2026 awareness month with a call for banks, fintechs and telecoms operators to share threat information as routine. The national response team recorded 3,876 incidents between January and July 2026, about 47% of them online fraud.

DIGITAL FRAUD INCIDENTS

- **Digital fraud incidents rise 98% between 2022 and 2025 – BoG** — MyJoyOnline, 10 September 2026

  Ghana's central bank says digital fraud incidents rose 98 per cent between 2022 and 2025 as financial criminals exploited the growth in digital transactions. Its second deputy governor said fraudsters increasingly targeting digital platforms, as more people pay and transfer electronically, requires a significant change in how financial crime is tackled.

GHANA CYBERSECURITY INDUSTRY FORUM

- **GCIF cautions public as criminals deploy AI in phishing attacks** — MyJoyOnline, 25 September 2026

  The Ghana Cybersecurity Industry Forum, the industry body provided for under the Cybersecurity Act, 2020, warned at an Accra news conference that criminals are using AI to make phishing messages convincing. It named a skills shortage as its main challenge and set out student engagement, a virtual assets workshop and community roadshows for October to December 2026.

CENTRAL BANK FRAUD INTELLIGENCE HUB

- **BoG to strengthen fraud control as digital finance grows** — GhanaWeb, 1 October 2026

The Bank of Ghana said on 1 October 2026 that it is building a fraud intelligence hub for financial institutions to share emerging fraud patterns, and has revised its Cyber and Information Security Directive for AI, cloud and data-security risks. Its information security director put mobile money flows above GH¢40 billion in June 2026.

CRITICAL INFORMATION INFRASTRUCTURE DESIGNATION

- **Ghana Strengthens Cyber Resilience for Critical Infrastructure** — Tech Africa News, 8 October 2026

  Ghana's communications minister said compliance with cybersecurity requirements is mandatory for the 13 designated critical information infrastructure sectors and about 200 owner institutions. He was opening a workshop on securing industrial control systems.

OPERATION BLACKOUT CYBERCRIME OPERATION

- **Sam George unhappy with FBI Director for not acknowledging Ghana's role in cybercrime operation** — MyJoyOnline, 8 October 2026

  Ghana's communications minister, Samuel Nartey George, objected that FBI Director Kash Patel's post on Operation Blackout did not credit Ghanaian agencies, reported on 8 October 2026. He said Ghana's Cyber Security Authority, police and national security staff led sting operations on 25–28 September with support from the UK National Crime Agency and the FBI; Patel's post cited more than 130 people detained and about US$10 million in losses.

- **Cyber Security Authority: Ghana led Operation Blackout, not FBI** — MyJoyOnline, 9 October 2026

  Ghana's Cyber Security Authority said Ghana, not the FBI, led Operation Blackout, which arrested eight suspects and rescued 120 suspected trafficking victims at cybercrime centres in Greater Accra. It asked the FBI to correct its public account, saying foreign agencies have no police powers in Ghana.

- **Ghana Rejects FBI-Led Claims Over Operation Blackout Cybercrime Raids** — Tech Africa News, 9 October 2026

  A second account of the Ghana Cyber Security Authority's statement on Operation Blackout: it names the Ghanaian, British, American and Nigerian agencies that took part and says the operation ran under Ghanaian authority.

Kenya

CYBER THREAT EVENTS RECORDED BY THE COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR

- **Web attacks up 44pc as hackers target State, ISP systems** — Daily Nation, 3 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya reported a 43.7% rise in web application attacks in the quarter to June 2026, with government systems and internet service providers the main targets. Total cyber threat events fell 30% to 2.36 billion. The regulator advised organisations to disable SSL 3.0, replace end-of-life products and apply patches promptly.

GUIDE TO THE INVESTIGATION AND PROSECUTION OF CYBERCRIME

- **Investigation and Prosecution of Offences Under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act, Cap 79C: A Rapid Reference Guide** — National Computer and Cybercrimes Coordination Committee (NC4), with the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions and the National Police Service, Kenya, 3 September 2026

Kenya's National Computer and Cybercrimes Coordination Committee, with the Director of Public Prosecutions and the National Police Service, launched a 140-page guide to investigating and prosecuting offences under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act on 3 September 2026. It covers 29 offences with 30 sample charges and seven court application templates, and omits sections 22 and 23, which the Court of Appeal declared unconstitutional.

- **Kenya unveils guide to standardise cybercrime investigation and prosecution** — The Star (Kenya), 3 September 2026

  Kenya launched a guide to investigating and prosecuting cybercrime under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act on 3 September 2026, listing 76 offences with sample cases. Internal Security Principal Secretary Raymond Omollo said it also covers cross-border cooperation and evidence preservation as Kenya pursues accession to the Budapest Convention. Cybercrime is put at about Sh29 billion a year.

NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY AGENCY

- **Safer cyberspace beckons as State firms up oversight agency** — The Star, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's National Cybersecurity Agency has a Director General in post but is not yet fully operational, according to a government implementation committee communiqué reported on 11 September 2026. Recruitment of technical and administrative staff and board appointments are still under way. Parliament received the memorandum for Legal Notice No. 89 of 2026, the order establishing the agency, in June.

- **CSs, CJ Koome Make New Appointments as Lorna Ogolla Joins NCA** — Kenyans.co.ke, 12 September 2026

  Kenya's interior cabinet secretary, Kipchumba Murkomen, appointed Lorna Ogolla Omondi and Jerop Joy Kibor to the board of the National Cybersecurity Agency for three-year terms, in a gazette notice dated 11 September 2026. The same round of notices named a chair and four members of the Kenya National Innovation Agency board.

- **Kenya Appoints Two Members To National Cybersecurity Agency Board** — CIO Africa, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's interior minister Kipchumba Murkomen appointed Lorna Omondi Ogolla and Joy Kibor to the board of the new National Cybersecurity Agency for three years, effective 11 September 2026 under Gazette Notice 14420. Ogolla leads Google Research's machine-learning and AI partnerships in Africa; Kibor heads postgraduate ICT studies at Zetech University.

NATIONAL COMPUTER INCIDENT RESPONSE CENTRE'S DIGITAL FORENSICS LABORATORY

- **Govt steps up safety against cybersecurity and data privacy** — The Standard, 7 October 2026

  Kenya's ICT minister told the Senate that the national incident response centre's digital forensics laboratory has received more than 200 investigation requests, most involving online abuse. A working group on online safety, a national referral directory and a review of gaps in the law have been agreed.

Liberia

CYBERCRIME ACT 2025

- **Liberia's Free-Speech Balancing Act and What the Cybercrime Law Actually Changed** — FrontPageAfrica, 11 September 2026

A FrontPageAfrica commentary compares Liberia's Cybercrime Act of 2025, whose printed text is marked approved on 3 July 2026, with the 2019 Kamara Abdullah Kamara Act that decriminalised sedition and criminal libel of the President. It sets out the Act's speech-related offences, including cyberstalking and harmful data messages, and a judge-ordered interception power. It also notes a pending amendment, introduced in March 2026, to criminalise insulting language online.

- **Liberia's New Cybercrime Law: The New Digital Police Power and the Fight Over Free Speech** — Smart News Liberia, 19 September 2026

  Liberia's Cybercrime Act of 2025 has been published as approved law, and its first public test is a warning by the Executive Protection Service director, Sam Gaye, that makers of manipulated material meant to insult or harass could be prosecuted. It followed an arrest over a doctored video of Vice-President Jeremiah Kpan Koung. The article weighs this against the constitution's free-expression guarantee.

- **Koung Seeks Release of AI Image Suspect** — The New Dawn Liberia, 21 September 2026

  Liberia's vice-president Jeremiah Koung asked for the release of Jerry Nyantee Wrotto, whom police detained under the Cybercrime Act over AI-made images and videos of Koung, and said he would not press charges. It is one of the first high-profile uses of the Act, signed on 19 August 2026 with the Data Protection Act. The head of the Executive Protection Service defended the arrest, while critics including former finance minister Samuel Tweah said the Act's cyberbullying clauses cover protected speech.

- **Liberia's Cybercrime Law Faces Its First Real Trial as VP Koung case exposes Liberia's widening fault lines** — FrontPage Africa, 21 September 2026

  A second account of the Wrotto arrest, summarised under the New Dawn report. It adds a justice ministry prosecutor's view that the state, not the vice-president, decides whether a prosecution goes ahead, and notes that the Act does not mention AI or deepfakes.

- **Liberia: CDC Prepares to Take Cybercrime Law Fight to Supreme Court After Wrato Release** — FrontPage Africa, 23 September 2026

  Liberia's opposition CDC says it will ask the Supreme Court to rule on the constitutionality of the Cybercrime Act of 2025. The move follows the court-ordered release on 22 September of commentator Jerry Nyantee Wrato, whom police intended to prosecute under the Act over AI-generated images of the Vice President.

- **Liberia: Judge Gives Police 'Last Opportunity' in Cybercrime Suspect's Detention Case** — FrontPage Africa, 25 September 2026

  A Monrovia criminal court gave the police a last opportunity to justify holding Jerry Nyantee Wrato, a suspect under the Cybercrime Act, after no officer appeared for the second time. The judge found the state had not shown the case was lawfully before the court and postponed the habeas corpus hearing to 25 September.

Libya

INTEGRATED NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY PLAN

- **مناقشة وضع خطة وطنية متكاملة للأمن السيبراني** — وكالة الأنباء الليبية (وال), 20 September 2026

  Libya's minister of state Mohammed bin Ghalboun chaired a meeting in Tripoli on 20 September 2026 on drawing up an integrated national cybersecurity plan, with the heads of the cybersecurity authority, the General Information Authority and the national information security authority. It covered cyber emergency plans, early warning, incident response and a joint mechanism to monitor compliance. No plan text or deadline was published.

NATIONAL OIL CORPORATION OIL-DATA LEAK INVESTIGATION

- **NOC officials in pre-trial detention for leaking sensitive oil-related data** — Libya Herald, 1 October 2026

  Libya's Attorney General's Office ordered two National Oil Corporation officials, one of them its director of information and digital transformation, into pre-trial detention over leaked oil-sector data. Data on fields, production, reserves and exploration passed to a foreign company contracted in 2023 for a sector study.

Malawi

CONSUMER EXPOSURE TO ONLINE SCAMS

- **MACRA sounds alarm over rising digital scams** — Malawi24, 4 September 2026

  The Malawi Communications Regulatory Authority issued a public warning about rising fraud against mobile money users, reported on 4 September 2026. It listed fake social cash transfer messages, spoofed transaction alerts, fake prizes and hijacked WhatsApp accounts. It said government bodies and charities running cash transfers do not ask beneficiaries for money by SMS or WhatsApp.

REGULATOR'S SOCIAL MEDIA MONITORING SYSTEM

- **Questions grow over Malawi's social media monitoring system amid oversight concerns** — Nyasa Times, 8 September 2026

  The Malawi Communications Regulatory Authority installed a social media monitoring system in January 2025 under a $1.5 million contract awarded to Hashcom Ghana Limited 15 days earlier. More than a year on, no published document shows whether it ran during the September 2025 election, what data it collected or who had access. MACRA declined to comment pending an audit.

- **PART 2: A Ghanaian contractor, a $1.5 million contract, and a surveillance system that remains unexplained** — Moz24h, 10 September 2026

  Malawi's communications regulator MACRA bought a $1.5 million social-media monitoring system from Ghana's Hashcom, and more than a year on no institution has said publicly what it collects or who can access it. Civil society letters to MACRA's board, Parliament and the President in early 2025 did not halt it. The human rights commission abandoned a planned inspection, citing a lack of technical expertise.

MOBILE-MONEY SCAMS TRACED TO PRISONS

- **90% of scams linked to prisons** — Malawi24, 15 September 2026

  Malawi's communications regulator, MACRA, said prisoners are behind up to 90% of reported mobile money scams, with Zomba Maximum Security Prison a major source. Methods include SIM swaps, fake promotions, calls demanding border clearance fees for non-existent parcels, and WhatsApp account takeovers. No measures by the prison service or network operators are reported.

Mauritania

INTERNET RESILIENCE SCORE

- **Mauritania — Internet Society Pulse country report** — Internet Society Pulse, 16 September 2026

  The Internet Society rates Mauritania's internet resilience at 43%, with 3% of the 1,000 most-visited websites served from local servers or caches against a 50% target. About 46% of the population uses the internet.

NATIONAL COMPUTER EMERGENCY RESPONSE TEAM

- **Avis d'Appel d'Offres National : mise en place du CSIRT national et du SOC RIAD** — Ministere de la Transformation Numerique et de la Modernisation de l'Administration (WARDIP PMU), 9 October 2026

  Mauritania's WARDIP project unit at the digital transformation ministry issued a national tender on 9 October 2026 to set up a national CSIRT and a security operations centre for RIAD, the government's high-speed intranet, paid from World Bank credit IDA-7445-MR. Bids are due on 17 November 2026 with a 950,000 MRU bid guarantee. No contract value is stated.

Mozambique

NATIONAL CYBER INCIDENT RESPONSE TEAM

- **Governo reforça medidas de segurança cibernética em Moçambique** — Agencia de Informacao de Mocambique, 8 October 2026

  Mozambique's communications and digital transformation minister, Américo Muchanga, said on 7 October 2026 that the Cybersecurity Law (Law 13/2026) and Cybercrimes Law (Law 14/2026) of 1 July are in force. A national network of incident response teams now covers government, the regulator INCM, the telecoms sector and four provinces, and the national cybersecurity strategy is being updated for 2026-2030.

RECORDED CYBERATTACKS AND CYBERCRIME CASES

- **Mozambique: Government updating national cybersecurity strategy** — Club of Mozambique, 12 October 2026

  Mozambique's communications minister said the national cybersecurity strategy for 2026 to 2030 is being updated and will be the main instrument for implementing the Cybersecurity Act. He put cyber incidents recorded in 2025 at about 39,600 and urged operators of critical infrastructure to set up their incident response teams.

Namibia

REGULATOR AS ROOT CERTIFICATION AUTHORITY

- **Government told to stop making citizens carry ID copies** — observer24.com.na, 1 September 2026

  Namibia's National Root Certification Authority, operated by the communications regulator at the top of the country's digital trust chain, is technically live after a key-signing ceremony; the electronic signature provisions of the transactions act took effect on 15 June 2026.

- **Home Affairs becomes Namibia's first certification service provider** — New Era, 3 September 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator, CRAN, accredited the Ministry of Home Affairs, Immigration, Safety and Security as the country's first certification service provider under the Electronic Transactions Act of 2019, announced in Windhoek in the week of 3 September 2026. The four-year accreditation lets the ministry issue digital certificates and encryption keys for government services, following a key signing ceremony on 28 August.

GLOBAL CYBERSECURITY INITIATIVE

- **Global Cybersecurity Initiative: Unifying Africa via Cybersecurity** — The Villager Newspaper, 4 September 2026

  DS Tech Namibia launched the Global Cybersecurity Initiative, a private pan-African platform to connect businesses, governments and innovators on cybersecurity, in Windhoek on 3 September 2026. Chaired by Paulinus Sheehama, it starts in Namibia, Kenya, Botswana, Ghana, Nigeria, Zambia and South Africa and aims to cover 52 African countries by 2029.

RANSOMWARE ATTACK ON THE NAMIBIAN DEFENCE FORCE

- **Hackers hit NDF: RansomHouse threatens state secrets** — The Namibian, 20 September 2026

  A ransomware group listed the Namibian Defence Force among its victims and published an evidence pack it says shows access to the force's systems, with a message accusing its IT department of concealing the incident. No confirmation or response from the force is on record, and the defence minister said he had not heard of it.

- **Namibia's Defence Ministry hit by double-extortion ransomware attack** — Tech News Namibia, 20 September 2026

  Namibia's national cyber incident response team, NAM-CSIRT, confirmed unauthorised activity on the Ministry of Defence and Veterans Affairs network and attributed it to the RansomHouse ransomware group, reported on 20 September 2026. It is coordinating investigation and recovery. It did not say what data was accessed, stolen or encrypted.

NATIONAL COMPUTER SECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE TEAM

- **CRAN appoints Cornelia Shipindo to lead Namibia's cyber incident response** — TechNews Namibia, 3 October 2026

  Cornelia Shipindo became Executive of the Namibia Cyber Security Incident Response Team on 1 October 2026, the Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia, which houses the team, announced. She will lead national incident response, threat preparedness and protection of critical information infrastructure.

NATIONAL PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Namibia strengthens digital trust** — Market Watch (Namibia Media Holdings), 4 October 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator launched DigiNam in Windhoek on 31 August as the public face of the national public key infrastructure, for which the regulator is root certification authority. It is meant to support electronic signatures, digital identity and authenticated online transactions under the Electronic Transactions Act of 2019.

Nigeria

NIGERIA POLICE FORCE NATIONAL CYBERCRIME CENTRE

- **Nigeria's police Vigilant app raises questions about cycle of duplicate fraud reporting platforms** — TechCabal, 7 September 2026

  The police fraud-reporting app launched on 1 September is the fourth police reporting platform in a decade, and it arrives over a cybercrime centre already logging about 146,000 reports and about ₦58bn in recovered assets. Nothing published says how the new channel routes against the centre already running, or what became of the earlier platforms.

COMMERCIAL BANK SPENDING ON CYBERSECURITY

- **First Bank spends N6bn annually to fight Cyber threats - Alebiosu** — Vanguard, 9 September 2026

  First Bank of Nigeria spends more than N6 billion a year on cybersecurity, its chief executive Olusegun Alebiosu said at the Chartered Institute of Bankers of Nigeria's annual conference. He said the bank monitors its systems around the clock, has set up a command centre and blocks millions of threats each month.

CYBER RESILIENCE FRAMEWORK FOR COMMUNICATIONS

- **CBN Demands Collective Defence Against Cyber, Technology Risks in Financial Sector** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

Nigeria's central bank warned that cybersecurity can no longer be treated as each bank's internal responsibility, because a vulnerability in one institution or technology provider can cascade through an increasingly interconnected financial system. Banks' growing reliance on fintechs, payment service providers and cloud operators has widened the channels through which incidents spread, it said, calling for a collective defence.

NATIONAL CERT THREAT ADVISORIES

- **ngCERT: Security Advisory on Escalating Cybersecurity Threats and Ongoing Attacks Targeting Organizations in Nigeria** — ngCERT (Nigerian Communications Commission), 15 September 2026

  The national computer emergency response team issued an advisory recording a significant rise in high-impact incidents across multiple sectors, driven by phishing, ransomware, business email compromise and data breaches, enabled by cybercrime-as-a-service models and AI-driven techniques.

- **Escalation of Ransomware Attacks in Nigeria** — ngCERT (Nigerian Communications Commission), 22 September 2026

  Nigeria's national CERT warned of rising Phobos ransomware attacks on cloud service providers whose clients include government agencies, banks and telecoms operators. It rates the damage critical and the probability high, and sets out mitigations.

Rwanda

REPORTED DIGITAL PAYMENT FRAUD CASES

- **Digital Payments Hit 3.1Billion, Fraud Complaints Drop 30%** — Taarifa Rwanda, 4 October 2026

  Rwanda's prime minister said reported financial fraud complaints fell by about 30% in the second quarter of 2026 from 4,128 a year earlier. Digital transactions rose from about 256 million in 2017 to 3.1 billion in 2025, and he said phone-based fraud remains a problem.

- **Rwanda cyber fraud falls 30%, but fund recovery remains low** — IGIHE, 8 October 2026

  The National Bank of Rwanda said on 8 October 2026 that financial-sector fraud cases fell to 2,879 in the second quarter of 2026 from 4,128 a year earlier, and the sums involved to Rwf471 million, but only 3.6% had been recovered. Governor Soraya Hakuziyaremye said electronic payments reached 341% of GDP in the first half of 2026.

Seychelles

SEYCHELLES NATIONAL CYBERDRILL

- **CERT-SC takes the lead in third Seychelles National Cyberdrill** — Seychelles Nation, 6 October 2026

  Seychelles' national computer emergency response team designed and delivered the country's third national cyberdrill itself for the first time. The two-day exercise tests how organisations detect, respond to and recover from cyberattacks.

Sierra Leone

ROAD SAFETY AUTHORITY VEHICLE LICENSING SYSTEM

- **SLRSA Alerts Public On Fake Vehicle Licences After Cyber Attack, 5 Arrested** — Sierra Leone Monitor, 5 October 2026

The Sierra Leone Road Safety Authority said in a public notice dated 2 October 2026 that an intrusion into its IT systems was used to produce fake vehicle licences. Police arrested five people who are not SLRSA staff. The number of fake licences in circulation was not disclosed, and owners are asked to verify licences at SLRSA offices.

NATIONAL INTERNET DOMAIN REGISTRY COMPROMISE OF 25 SEPTEMBER 2026

- **Sierra Leone: Government confirms cyberattack on 44 websites** — This Day (Salone), 9 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's communications ministry confirmed that 44 website addresses, one a government institution's, were hit on 25 September through the system that administers the national internet domain. Service was restored the same day; how the attackers got in has not been made public.

South Africa

HUNGRY LION CUSTOMER CREDENTIAL EXPOSURE

- **Hungry Lion customer creds online for months** — ITWeb, 1 September 2026

  Customer credentials for the fast-food chain Hungry Lion were exposed for about nine months through its consumer-facing web portals, on analysis of stealer-log data finding 23 records tied to its South African domain, 13 of them customer accounts.

BULK WATER UTILITY CYBER SECURITY INCIDENT

- **Hackers breach Rand Water's defences** — ITWeb South Africa, 4 September 2026

  Rand Water, Africa's largest bulk water utility and supplier to more than 16 million people, disclosed a cyber security incident on 3 September and is operating from its Centurion disaster-recovery site while it establishes the extent of the damage. Its debt officer said intruders reached some servers at night before IT staff could block them and that some servers were damaged; water treatment, quality control and bulk supply are stated to remain fully operational.

THIRD-PARTY SERVICE PROVIDER BREACHES AFFECTING A TELECOM OPERATOR, AN INVESTMENT PLATFORM, A BANK AND A FINANCIAL SERVICES GROUP

- **SA's Cell C, EasyEquities and Bidvest Bank warn customers of data leak** — Connecting Africa, 14 September 2026

  Cell C, EasyEquities and Bidvest Bank notified South African customers of a breach at an unnamed third-party provider, reported on 9 September. Cell C Fiber customers' names, emails, numbers and account numbers were exposed; Bidvest Bank's exposure awaits a forensic investigation.

- **Third-party cyber breaches rock SA firms** — ITWeb South Africa, 17 September 2026

  Four South African financial and telecommunications names disclosed customer-data exposure that began at third-party suppliers rather than in their own systems, and a separate supplier breach is said to have compromised information held for about 45 insurers. One financial services group suspended data sharing with its screening supplier and reinstated the service only after forensic sign-off and credential replacement.

COMMERCIAL SECURITY OPERATIONS CENTRE, CAPE TOWN

- **Integrity360 invests R55m in CT base and its largest SOC** — ITWeb South Africa, 15 September 2026

  A 40-desk security operations centre opened in Cape Town on 14 September under a R55m investment, providing monitoring and incident response for customers across Africa and internationally, and stated to create about 100 jobs over three years.

MIP HOLDINGS INSURANCE-TECHNOLOGY BREACH

- **Hollard rejects hacking claim, points to MIP cyber breach** — ITWeb South Africa, 16 September 2026

  An extortion attack on insurance technology provider MIP Holdings, detected on 14 June 2026, exposed personal data linked to customers of about 45 South African insurers. Hollard said a ransomware group's claim against it traced to that incident, not to its own systems.

- **Hackers turn on insurers after MIP paid the ransom** — TechCentral, 18 September 2026

  The group behind the June breach at an insurance software supplier is now extorting South African insurers directly, after the supplier paid a ransom for an undertaking to destroy the data. Material on a leak site includes policyholders' names, their children's names, identity numbers and email addresses; about 45 insurers' customers were exposed.

- **Hollard data hits dark web after MIP hack** — ITWeb South Africa, 18 September 2026

  Data allegedly stolen from a South African insurer appeared on the dark web, a researcher confirming it is public, after the June attack on its software supplier. The criminal group had demanded a ransom from the insurer to keep it private.

SUSPECTED BREACH OF THE ENATIS VEHICLE DATABASE

- **Inside the fake AARTO fine scam** — ITWeb South Africa, 18 September 2026

  South Africa's road traffic infringement agency is considering an investigation into whether the national vehicle database was accessed, after fake traffic-fine messages began quoting motorists' correct number plates. The fines platform being impersonated says its own system was not breached.

GAUTENG E-PANIC BUTTON APP DATA EXPOSURE

- **Gauteng panic app exposed crime reports and your locations** — GroundUp, 23 September 2026

  GroundUp reported on 23 September 2026 that the database behind the Gauteng Department of e-Government's e-Panic Button app was unsecured, exposing users' names, crime reports with images, GPS location histories and login PINs. Contractor Evolve VAS, which holds a R10 million contract, fixed the flaws after GroundUp's alert on 21 September; the provincial government did not respond.

- **Gauteng spending R269 million for app downloaded 15,000 times in 10 months** — MyBroadband, 25 September 2026

  Gauteng's Department of e-Government said in replies to DA questions, reported on 25 September 2026, that its e-Panic Button contract with Evolve Value Added Services is worth R269 million in total and runs to 10 March 2027. It has paid R131.3 million over three years, and the app gained only 15,000 new downloads between October 2025 and August 2026, out of more than 180,000 overall.

- **DA to report e-Panic button data breach to Information Regulator of South Africa** — Democratic Alliance Gauteng, 28 September 2026

  South Africa's opposition DA in Gauteng will ask the Information Regulator to investigate the exposure of data from the provincial e-Panic Button app, including crime reporters' names, reports, photos and locations. It says the department did not inform the legislature's oversight committee.

- **DA to report e-Panic data breach to Information Regulator** — GroundUp, 28 September 2026

South Africa's Democratic Alliance said it will report a data breach in the Gauteng government's e-Panic Button app to the Information Regulator, reported on 28 September 2026. An unsecured database exposed crime reports with the names, phone numbers and locations of those who filed them. Nearly a week after the disclosure, the province had not commented or told affected users; the contract is reported at R269m.

- **Gauteng e-government assures panic button app data is secure despite security breach** — The Citizen, 29 September 2026

  Gauteng's e-government department said the flaw in its e-Panic Button app is patched and no personal data was compromised, and put active users at 288,307. The student who reported the flaw disputes that account, saying ID numbers, addresses and crime details were exposed unencrypted.

- **Information Regulator to engage Gauteng over e-Panic Button data breach** — Mail & Guardian, 30 September 2026

  South Africa's Information Regulator said it had received no breach notification from Gauteng's e-government department over the exposed e-Panic Button database and would engage the department, noting it can issue an information notice.

- **e-Panic Button security flaw sparks legislature probe** — ITWeb South Africa, 1 October 2026

  A Gauteng legislature committee said it will examine whether the provincial e-government department's earlier assurances about the e-Panic Button's security were accurate. The department says an attempted breach was identified and fixed and that no personal information was compromised.

- **Gauteng committee demands answers after e-Panic Button app data breach sparks outrage** — The Citizen (South Africa), 1 October 2026

  The Gauteng legislature's e-government committee rejected the provincial department's assurance that no personal information was compromised by the e-Panic Button exposure, and gave it seven days to report. It wants an incident timeline, proof of notification to the Information Regulator and residents, and the contract's data-protection clauses.

- **ACCOUNTABILITY OVER ALLEGED E-PANIC BUTTON SECURITY BREACH - Yo School Mag** — Yo School Mag, 8 October 2026

  Gauteng legislature committees said after a joint meeting on 5 October 2026 that the provincial Department of e-Government notified the Information Regulator of the e-Panic Button data exposure only that morning, about two weeks after being alerted on 21 September. The department could not say how many records were exposed, and the committees demanded an investigation independent of the app's service provider.

- **'You didn't need to bypass any access controls': Gauteng eGov weighs charges over e-panic button flaw** — The Citizen, 19 October 2026

  Gauteng's e-Government department said on 19 October 2026 it will decide whether to pursue criminal charges against student Joel Cedras, who exposed a flaw in the e-Panic Button app, once an investigation report due the following week is in. The DA's Michael Waters said the department had sought his prosecution, and that police advised the app's developers would have to open the case.

CYBER CRIME VICTIM HELPLINE PILOT

- **Free cyber crime victim helpline launches** — ITWeb South Africa, 14 October 2026

MiDO Academy and the UK charity The Cyber Helpline, funded by Amazon Web Services, began a 12-month pilot of a free, 24-hour cyber crime victim helpline in South Africa for anyone aged 13 or over. Supervised MiDO students answer calls and refer victims to banks, the police and mental health services.

PAYMENT SYSTEM CYBERSECURITY AND CYBER-RESILIENCE DIRECTIVE (DIRECTIVE 1 OF 2024)

- **Regulation (National Payment System Department)** — South African Reserve Bank, 17 October 2026

  The South African Reserve Bank explains how its National Payment System Department regulates the payment system for safety, efficiency and stability, including the prevention of fraud and money laundering. It says consumer protection in payments is the job of the Financial Sector Conduct Authority.

Sudan

NATIONAL MECHANISM FOR COMBATING INFORMATION CRIMES

- **رئيس مجلس الوزراء يصدر قراراً بتشكيل الآلية الوطنية لمكافحة جرائم المعلوماتية** — Sudan News Agency (SUNA), 19 October 2026

  Sudan's prime minister issued a decision on 19 October 2026 forming a National Mechanism to Combat Informatics Crimes, chaired by an assistant attorney general. It is tasked with combating cybercrime and publications deemed harmful to the state and society, monitoring media and social platforms, and taking preventive and legal action, including lawsuits on the state's behalf.

Tanzania

REPORTED MOBILE FRAUD AND ONLINE SCAM CASES

- **TCRA steps up fight against mobile fraud in Morogoro** — The Citizen, 10 September 2026

  Tanzania's communications regulator ran a three-day awareness campaign in Morogoro against mobile phone fraud and online scams. It put the national caseload at 7,334 reported cases, of which 2,495 or 34 per cent came from Rukwa and 2,079 or 28.4 per cent from Morogoro.

SIM-REGISTRATION FRAUD ENFORCEMENT

- **New push for tighter SIM registration to curb cyber fraud** — The Citizen, 10 September 2026

  Communications stakeholders in Rukwa have proposed tighter SIM card registration controls, including a 24-hour waiting period before a person may register another line, as the region records a high number of reported cyber-fraud cases. They also want the communications regulator to work more closely with other agencies on enforcement.

Togo

NATIONAL POOL OF CYBERSECURITY PROFESSIONALS

- **Togo Builds Cybersecurity Talent Pool as Digital Threats Intensify** — Ecofin Agency, 3 September 2026

  Togo's National Cybersecurity Agency (ANCy) issued a call for expressions of interest, dated 27 August 2026 and published on 2 September, to build a national pool of cybersecurity professionals it can call on. Applications close on 30 October 2026. The pool covers fields from incident response and digital forensics to data protection, in support of the 2024–2028 National Cybersecurity Strategy.

Tunisia

CIRCULAR REQUIRING A COMMON SECURITY BASELINE FOR PUBLIC DIGITAL SYSTEMS

- **Cybersécurité : la Cheffe du gouvernement tunisienne appelle les organismes publics à appliquer les bonnes pratiques** — Tunisie Haut Débit, 3 September 2026

  Tunisia's head of government Sarra Zaafrani Zenzri issued circular no. 5 on 2 September 2026, setting security rules for public bodies' digital systems based on a technical note by the cybersecurity agency ANSI. It requires approved hosting, HTTPS on all pages, multi-factor authentication, an ANSI-accredited audit before launch and yearly after, DDoS protection and .tn domains.

- **Cybersécurité : le grand tournant pour l''administration ?** — La Presse de Tunisie, 5 September 2026

  An analysis of the head of government's circular of 2 September sets out what it requires of the administration: encrypted connections, mandatory renewal of security certificates, two-factor verification for administrator access, protection against traffic-saturation attacks and hosting on state-approved servers, with messaging apps and social media banned for official documents and shared credentials ended. It binds the administration rather than the wider economy, and carries no compliance deadline.

Uganda

CENTRAL BANK INTERNAL SECURITY SYSTEMS

- **Bank of Uganda strengthens security measures** — ITWeb Africa, 9 September 2026

  Bank of Uganda's governor told Parliament's Public Accounts Committee that the central bank has strengthened its internal security systems after a physical break-in and allegations of system manipulation at its headquarters. He said the incidents involved a physical breach and fraudulent payments rather than an external cyberattack.

FINANCIAL-SECTOR CYBER AND FRAUD INCIDENTS

- **Uganda Records 6,533 Cyber and Fraud Incidents, Losses Hit Shs24bn** — Nile Post, 23 September 2026

  The Uganda Bankers' Association counted 6,533 cyber and fraud incidents in the financial sector from January to August 2026, with UGX 24 billion lost and a further UGX 68 billion estimated at risk. At the same forum the Deputy Chief Justice said the judiciary is open to specialised handling of cyber and financial crime.

Zimbabwe

CYBERSECURITY OF INDUSTRIAL CONTROL NETWORKS AT A PLATINUM MINE

- **Rockwell secures Mimosa Mine control networks in Zimbabwe** — Tech Africa, 2 September 2026

  Rockwell Automation said on 1 September 2026 that it had completed a cybersecurity and modernisation project at Zimbabwe's Mimosa platinum mine with local distributor Mine Elect. The work covered network architecture, segmentation of control systems, and controls on system access, data transfer, monitoring and recovery. No contract value, timeline or prompting incident is given.

INVESTIGATION INTO WHATSAPP BUSINESS ACCOUNT TAKEOVERS

- **Govt probes mass WhatsApp takeovers in Zimbabwe** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera said her ministry has opened a multi-agency investigation, including the police Cyber Crime Division, into a wave of WhatsApp Business account takeovers. It will examine whether personal or financial data was compromised and the role of SMS termination aggregators, and is engaging Meta and the affected mobile operator.

CYBERSECURITY FRAMEWORK FOR CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE PROTECTION

> - **POTRAZ moves to tighten cybersecurity for critical infrastructure** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 15 October 2026
>
>   Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator is developing a Cybersecurity Framework for Critical Infrastructure Protection, its draft regulation cited as a governance example at a regulators' follow-up meeting in Nairobi. The regulator also restated that data controllers must be licensed under the Cyber and Data Protection Act.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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